

French

(A Level, AQA)

"It is arrogant to assume that we can get by in English or that everyone else will speak our language. Learning a foreign language is polite, demonstrates commitment – and in today's world is absolutely necessary."

Sir Trevor MacDonald, Chair, Nuffield Language Inquiry

The A level French course builds on the knowledge, understanding and skills gained at GCSE. You will gain a range of transferable skills including communication, critical thinking, research skills and creativity. As well as developing your language skills, you will widen your knowledge and understanding of themes relating to the culture and societies where French is spoken. Examples include technological and social changes, highlights of French-speaking artistic culture, including francophone music and cinema, and who wields political power in the French-speaking world. The most successful A level linguists have always shown a commitment to and an enjoyment of the subject which extends way beyond the classroom. We encourage you to read foreign language magazines, newspapers and books, participate in theatre and cinema visits, and attend lectures out of school. We also encourage you to arrange an exchange visit, a study trip or work experience in a French-speaking country.

Entry Requirements:

Grade 6 in GCSE French.

Course Content

Units	%	When?	Content
Paper 1: Listening, Reading and Writing 2 hours 30 minutes	50%	June 2027	Listening and responding to spoken passages from a range of contexts and sources Reading and responding to a variety of texts written for different purposes, drawn from authentic resources Translation from French into English Translation from English into French
Paper 2: Writing 2 hours	20%	June 2027	Either one Question in French on a set text, or one question on a set film, or two questions on set texts. Questions will require a critical and analytical response to the work studied.
Paper 3: Speaking 21 - 23 minutes	30%	May 2027	Discussion of a sub-theme based on a stimulus card (5 - 6 minutes) Presentation (2 minutes) and discussion (9 - 10 minutes) of individual research project

A one year AS qualification in French is also available and will be examined in May/June 2026.

Costs associated with this course

Essential: Textbook: AQA French A level and Year 1 (ISBN: 978-0-19-836688-1) Paperback 19/05/2016 Cost approximately £29.99, second hand books are often available.

Recommended: A good French grammar book- e.g. Action Grammaire (ISBN: 978-0340915240)

Mot à Mot vocabulary book (ISBN: 978-1510434806)

Career Links

You could study French at degree level either alone or as part of a combined degree, and you will have developed the skills to learn new languages. A variety of career options is open to students of French, whether you choose to work at home or abroad, for example in business, engineering, scientific research, technology, journalism, international aid, media, entertainment, the leisure industry or teaching.

For more information please contact Miss Young